

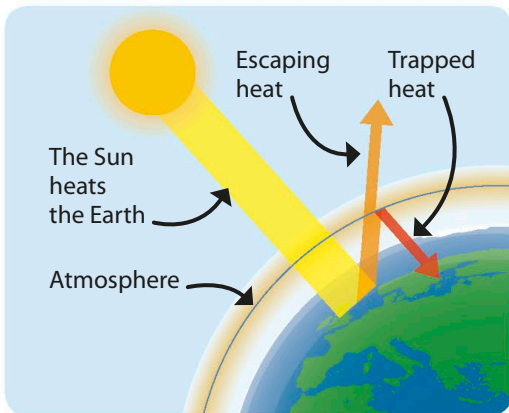
Fossil fuels

Coal, oil, and natural gas are fuels that contain a lot of stored energy. We call them fossil fuels. They are made from the remains of fossilized plants and animals that were alive millions of years ago. Fossil fuels burn easily, and release lots of energy as heat when they burn. Their energy is useful for many things, including making electricity in power stations.



Greenhouse gases

The gases in our atmosphere trap some of the heat from the Sun around the Earth, just like a greenhouse. Burning fossil fuels produces carbon dioxide gas, which traps heat. Too much carbon dioxide in the atmosphere causes the planet to warm up.



Carbon dioxide in the atmosphere traps heat energy.

Coal

Coal contains energy from the Sun that was stored by plants that were alive when dinosaurs roamed the Earth. These plants were buried, then squashed and heated until they became coal.

Coal is dug up from the ground as a shiny, black rock.

